months by the 1950s, meaning that seasonal unemployment skyrocketed.[5]

While Cuba's small middle and upper classes, who resided primarily in Havana, enjoyed reasonably high levels of access to education, health care, and urban amenities, the majority of the population was rural and poor – what Cubans called *guajiros*. Swedish economist Claes Brunendius described a typical *guajiro's* life this way: "He lived in a *bohío*, a small house with an earthen floor and a roof made of palm thatch. For 90 percent of the *guajiros*, a kerosene lamp was the only form of lighting, and 44 percent of them had never attended school. Only 11 percent drank milk, only 4 percent ate meat, and only 2 percent ate eggs. The daily diet, which had a deficiency of 1,000 calories, was the main reason for a constant increase in the number of cases of tuberculosis, anemia, parasitic diseases, and other illnesses."[6]

Dependency also affected the relatively privileged urban sectors, though. "The modern Cuban eats hot dogs, hamburgers, hot cakes, waffles, fried chicken and ice cream," commented an American journalist in 1957. "It has become almost impossible in Havana today to find native foods such as *malanga*, *yuca*, *picadillo* or *ajiaco*."[7] Though something of an exaggeration – in fact small food stands continued to offer traditional Cuban foods throughout the city – the observation reflected an overall reality that many Cubans saw as a decidedly mixed blessing. "The Cuban is unfortunately fading into the distant past," wrote one commentator in the 1920s. "Soon … there will be nothing remaining except a stylized caricature of the *yanki* … where chewing gum and tortoiseshell eye glasses will complete our conversion into puppets 'Made in the U.S'."[8] It was the same problem José Martí had critiqued in the 1870s: "Our youth go out into the world wearing Yankee- or French-colored glasses and aspire to rule by guesswork a country they do not know." And his solution: "Statesmen who arise from the nation must replace statesmen who are alien to it … Make wine from plantains, it may be sour, but it is our wine!"[9]

Breaking the economic and psychological dependency on the United States was clearly to be an overriding goal of the Revolution. But Cuban